

The only AI tools you need in 2026

One pick for ten jobs, from research to content

10 jobs

1 pick each

THE LINEUP

Ten jobs, one pick each

01

**Easy
research**

02

**Advanced
research**

03

Coding

04

Design

05

**Computer
use**

06

AI video

07

AI images

08

**Sales
assistant**

09

**Cold
email**

10

**Content
writing**

PICK 1 OF 10

Easy automated research

MY PICK

Grokbot

From xAI

WHAT IT IS

An app for building named AI agents. No code needed.

WHY IT IS THE EASY PICK

Name the agent, connect your tools, and put it on a schedule.

PICK 2 OF 10

Advanced automated research

MY PICK

Hermes + Hetzner

An open source agent on your own server

WHAT IT IS

Hermes Agent is open source from Nous Research. Hetzner is the cloud server it runs on.

WHY IT IS THE ADVANCED PICK

You are building machines in the cloud. It becomes your own suite of software.

PICK 3 OF 10

Coding

MY PICK

Claude Code

From Anthropic, on Opus 5.5

MY TAKE

The best for coding, by far.

MY FALLBACK

When I run out of usage, I switch to DeepSeek on the OpenCode Go plan.

PICK 4 OF 10

Design

MY PICK

Claude Design

From Anthropic

WHAT IT IS

Describe what you want and get designs, prototypes, and slides back.

WHAT I MAKE WITH IT

Landing pages, thumbnails, and a design system for the brand.

PICK 5 OF 10

Computer use

MY PICK

OpenAI

ChatGPT with GPT-6 Astra

WHAT COMPUTER USE MEANS

The AI clicks, types, and browses on a computer the way you would.

FROM MY 48 HOUR TEST

Strong at browser tasks. It signed in and cleared two factor on its own.

PICK 6 OF 10

AI video

MY PICK

Google Veo 3

From Google

WHAT IT IS

Give Veo a prompt or a reference image and it makes the clip.

WHY IT WINS FOR ME

The best for consistency, cost, and speed when you make video at scale.

PICK 7 OF 10

AI images

MY PICK

Nano Banana

From Google, inside Gemini

WHAT IT IS

Nano Banana creates and edits images inside Gemini.

HOW IT PAIRS WITH VIDEO

Make the still image here, then hand it to Veo to turn it into video.

PICK 8 OF 10

Sales assistant

MY PICK

OpenAI Dots

An always on agent in ChatGPT

MY TAKE

A really great copilot for sales work.

FROM MY 48 HOUR TEST

Connected to Slack and email, it offers to take work off my plate.

PICK 9 OF 10

Cold email

MY PICK

Claude + Omega

Claude connected to our second brain

HOW WE RUN IT

We connect Claude to Omega, our second brain product.

WHAT OMEGA ADDS

Business context: what we do, what we have done, and what we plan.

PICK 10 OF 10

Content writing

MY PICK

Claude + ScrapeCreators

Claude with live social data

MY TAKE

Claude is really good at content writing.

MY BEST ADVICE

Do not accept the first answer. Push back and it gets better.

THE RECAP

The cheat sheet

01

EASY RESEARCH

Grokbot

02

ADVANCED RESEARCH

Hermes + Hetzner

03

CODING

Claude Code

04

DESIGN

Claude Design

05

COMPUTER USE

OpenAI

06

AI VIDEO

Google Veo 3

07

AI IMAGES

Nano Banana

08

SALES ASSISTANT

OpenAI Dots

09

COLD EMAIL

Claude + Omega

10

CONTENT WRITING

Claude + ScrapeCreators

THE TAKEAWAY

Ten jobs, five makers

No single AI won every job on my list. Pick the tool for the job.

xAI, Nous Research, Anthropic, OpenAI, Google

Which pick would you change?

Tell me your stack in the comments

[Comment your stack](#)

Education only. My opinions as of October 2026.